

why Amazon and Google failed to following fields Enterprise Data Analytics Data Warehousing AI on Company Data

Actually, **Amazon and Google did not fail**. That's the key point.

All three are successful:

Company	Product
Amazon Web Services	Amazon Redshift
Google Cloud	BigQuery
Snowflake	Snowflake

The real question is:

Why did Snowflake grow so fast even when Amazon and Google already existed?

Reason 1: Snowflake Was Neutral

Imagine you're a large bank.

If you choose Google:

Google Cloud only

If you choose AWS:

AWS only

Snowflake said:

Use AWS
or Azure
or Google Cloud

This was a huge advantage.

Reason 2: Enterprises Hate Vendor Lock-In

Companies fear:

If all data is inside AWS
I may never leave AWS

or

If all data is inside Google
I may never leave Google

Snowflake reduced that fear.

Reason 3: Focus

Google works on:

Search
Android
YouTube
Gemini
Maps
Ads
Cloud

Amazon works on:

E-commerce
AWS
Prime Video
Logistics
Alexa

Snowflake works mostly on:

Data
Analytics
Data Sharing

Enterprise AI

A specialist can sometimes outperform a giant in one niche.

Reason 4: Simplicity

Around 2015-2022 many companies felt:

AWS

Very powerful
Many services
More complexity

Snowflake

Simpler experience

Managers loved this.

Reason 5: Data Sharing

Snowflake introduced easy data sharing.

Example:

Company A



Snowflake



Company B

without copying huge datasets.

This became very popular.

Then Why Didn't Google Crush Snowflake?

Because Google earns most money from:

Advertising
Search
YouTube

Google Cloud is important, but not Google's main profit engine.

Snowflake had only one mission:

Become the best data platform

What Happened After AI?

This is where things changed.

Before AI:

Snowflake strong
Google strong
AWS strong

After Generative AI:

Data + AI became critical

Now Google has:

- Gemini
- Vertex AI

Amazon has:

- Bedrock
- SageMaker

Microsoft has:

- Azure AI

- OpenAI partnership

Snowflake has:

- Cortex AI
 - Cortex Analyst
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Who Is Winning Today?

For AI models:

🏆 Google, OpenAI, Anthropic, Microsoft

For cloud infrastructure:

🏆 AWS

For enterprise data platforms:

🏆 Snowflake is one of the leaders

For AI on enterprise data:

🏆 The competition is ongoing.

For the Next 5 Years

Many experts believe the future will look like:

Company Data



Snowflake / BigQuery / Databricks



Gemini / GPT / Claude



Business AI Assistant

So the likely future is **not Snowflake replacing Google**.

Instead:

Snowflake + Gemini
Snowflake + GPT
Snowflake + Claude

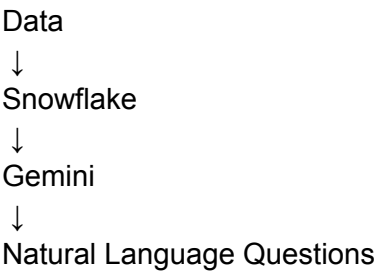
working together.

That's why companies pay for both a data platform and an AI platform. One stores and organizes the company's knowledge; the other reasons over it.

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Feature	Snowflake	Gemini AI Studio
Purpose	Data Platform	AI Model Platform
Stores Data	✔ Yes	✗ No
SQL Queries	✔ Yes	✗ No
Analytics	✔ Excellent	Limited
Train ML Models	✔ Some support	✗ Not for training
Build Chatbots	Limited	✔ Excellent
Generate Text	Limited	✔ Excellent
Generate Images	✗	✔ (via Google AI models)
Enterprise Data	✔ Excellent	✗ Not designed for this
Personal AI Projects	✗ Overkill	✔ Excellent

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Answers

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Snowflake becomes much more valuable when you move into **Data Engineering, Data Analytics, Cloud Data Platforms, or Enterprise AI systems.**

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The Snowflake Story — How a Small Idea Became a \$80+ Billion Company







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Chapter 1: The Problem (Around 2010)

Imagine you are running a large company.

Your data is everywhere:

Sales → Oracle

Customers → Salesforce

Reports → Excel

Logs → AWS

Finance → SAP

Management asks:

"How much profit did we make last month?"

The IT team spends days collecting data.

At that time, databases were designed for an older world:

- Physical servers
 - Data centers
 - Expensive hardware
 - Difficult scaling
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Chapter 2: Three Engineers See an Opportunity

Three database experts:

- Benoit Dageville
- Thierry Cruanes
- Marcin Zukowski

had worked on database technology for years.

They noticed something important:

Cloud computing is growing.

Databases are still designed for old servers.

Their idea:

"Let's build a database specifically for the cloud."

This was a radical idea at the time.

Chapter 3: The Name "Snowflake"

People often think the name came from snow.

Partly true.

But the founders also liked the idea that:

Every snowflake is unique.

Every company's data is unique.

The name was simple and memorable.

Chapter 4: The Secret Weapon

Most databases worked like this:

Storage + Compute = Together

Need more speed?

Buy bigger server.

Need more storage?

Buy bigger server.

Expensive.

Snowflake introduced:

Storage



Compute

Separate.

Companies loved it.

Chapter 5: Nobody Knew Them

In the beginning:

Google

Amazon

Microsoft

Oracle

IBM

were already giants.

Snowflake was a tiny startup.

Most people had never heard of it.

Many thought:

"Why would anyone choose a startup over Oracle?"

Chapter 6: The Multi-Cloud Bet

This was the genius move.

Amazon said:

Use AWS

Google said:

Use Google Cloud

Snowflake said:

Use AWS

or Azure

or Google Cloud

Companies loved this freedom.

Chapter 7: Enterprises Start Joining

One company joined.

Then another.

Then hundreds.

Then thousands.

Customers realized:

Less complexity

Fast analytics

Cloud-native design

Snowflake started growing rapidly.

Chapter 8: The Famous CEO

In 2019, Frank Sloatman became CEO.

He was known for building successful tech companies.

His mission:

Grow aggressively

Win enterprise customers

Snowflake's growth accelerated.

Chapter 9: The Historic IPO

In 2020:

Snowflake went public.

The IPO became one of the biggest software IPOs in history.

The surprise:

Warren Buffett's company invested before the IPO.

People were shocked because Buffett rarely invests in young tech companies.

Suddenly everyone wanted to know:

"What is Snowflake?"

Chapter 10: The AI Revolution

Then AI arrived.

Companies realized:

AI is powerful.

But AI needs company data.

Snowflake already had the data.

This created a huge opportunity.

Chapter 11: Cortex AI

Snowflake launched AI products such as:

- Cortex AI
- Cortex Analyst

Now users can ask:

Which product generated the most revenue?

instead of writing SQL.

Exactly like the screenshot you showed earlier.

Chapter 12: The Modern Vision

Today the vision looks like:

Company Data

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Snowflake

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AI Models

(Gemini, GPT, Claude)

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Business Answers

The Biggest Lesson

Snowflake did **not** beat Google, Amazon, or Microsoft.

Instead, it found a problem they weren't focused on enough:

Enterprise Data

and became one of the best companies in that niche.

Entrepreneur Lesson

The founders didn't ask:

"How can we become bigger than Google?"

They asked:

"What important problem is still unsolved?"

Solving that problem turned a small startup into one of the most valuable software companies in the world.

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Snowflake Company Timeline & Investment Story

When Was Snowflake Founded?

Snowflake was founded in **2012** by:

- Benoit Dageville
- Thierry Cruanes
- Marcin Zukowski

Their goal was to build a cloud-native data warehouse from scratch.

How Old Is Snowflake Today?

Founded: 2012

Current Year: 2026

Age: About 14 years

How Much Money Did They Raise?

Early Stage (2012)

Initial funding:

About \$26 Million

from venture capital investors.

Growth Stage

Over several funding rounds:

2014–2020

Snowflake raised approximately:

\$1.4 Billion

before going public.

Major Funding Round

In 2020:

\$479 Million

was raised in a single round, valuing the company at:

\$12.4 Billion

before the IPO.

IPO (Stock Market Launch)

In September 2020:

Raised: More than \$3 Billion

through its IPO, one of the largest software IPOs ever.

Growth Journey

Year	Milestone
2012	Company founded
2014	First major funding
2015	Product launched publicly
2018	Valuation reached ~\$1.5B
2020	Valuation reached ~\$12.4B
2020	IPO raised >\$3B
2026	Market value around \$80B+

What Can You Learn From This?

The founders did **not** start with billions.

They started with:

Problem:

Companies have data everywhere.

Solution:

Build a better cloud data warehouse.

For about **8 years (2012–2020)** they focused almost entirely on solving that one problem before the company became famous.

Lesson for AI/ML Students

Many successful companies start with:

1. One clear problem
2. A focused solution
3. Years of execution

Snowflake's founders weren't trying

to build "the next Google." They picked a specific pain point—enterprise data warehousing—and became one of the best in the world at it.

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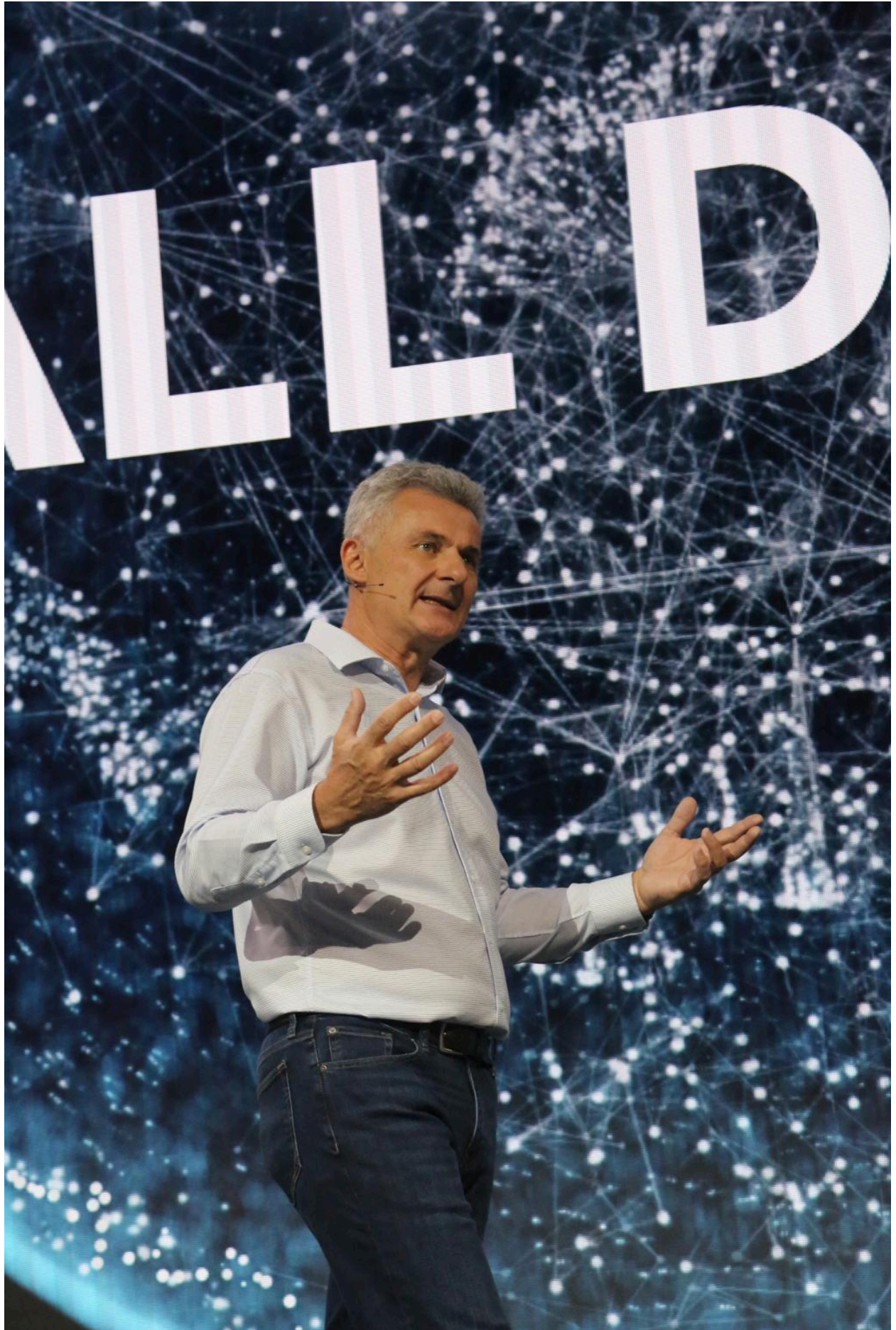
- Benoit Dageville
- Thierry Cruanes
- Marcin Zukowski

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There is **limited public information about their childhoods**. They are not celebrities who wrote detailed autobiographies. What is publicly known is mainly their education and career journey.

1. Benoit Dageville







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Country

 France (French entrepreneur)

Education

- PhD in Computer Science
- Specialized in Parallel Database Systems

Early Career

Started working at:

- Bull Information Systems

He worked on high-performance database systems.

Oracle Years

Joined:

- Oracle Corporation

Worked there for about 15 years.

Responsibilities:

- Database architecture
- Parallel processing
- Performance optimization

He became one of Oracle's top database architects.

Snowflake Journey

In 2012 he saw cloud computing growing and realized databases needed a completely new architecture. Together with Thierry and Marcin, he co-founded Snowflake.

Interesting Fact

He holds:

- More than 80 patents according to Snowflake's profile
 - Other public profiles report hundreds of patents across his career.
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2. Thierry Cruanes





Country

 France (French technologist)

Education

- PhD in Computer Science
- Specialized in Database Systems

Early Career

Worked at:

- IBM

Specifically at IBM's European Center of Applied Mathematics.

Worked on:

- Data mining
- Database research

for about 7 years.

Oracle Years

Moved to Oracle.

Spent around 13 years there.

Focused on:

- Query optimization
- Database performance
- Parallel execution

Eventually led Oracle's optimization group.

Snowflake Journey

When cloud adoption accelerated, Thierry and Benoit believed traditional databases were not designed for the cloud era.

That belief became Snowflake.

Interesting Fact

He owns more than 40 patents in database technologies.

3. Marcin Zukowski







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Country

 Poland (Polish entrepreneur and computer scientist)

Childhood & Education

Grew up in Poland.

Later became deeply involved in computer science and database research.

Earned a doctorate from:

- University of Amsterdam

His doctoral work became influential in database technology.

First Startup

Before Snowflake, Marcin founded:

- Vectorwise

A database company based on his research.

The company was eventually acquired, making him a successful entrepreneur before Snowflake.

Snowflake Journey

After Vectorwise, he moved to California and joined Benoit and Thierry in building Snowflake.

Many of Snowflake's high-performance database ideas came from research areas Marcin had worked on for years.

Common Pattern Among All Three

What is fascinating is that none of them became successful overnight.

Study Computer Science



PhD Research



Database Engineering



10–15+ Years Experience



Become Experts



Start Snowflake



8+ Years of Growth



Historic IPO

Biggest Lesson

All three founders spent **decades becoming world-class database experts before starting Snowflake.**

They were not college students chasing a trend. They first became experts in a very specific field:

Databases



Cloud Databases



Snowflake

That deep expertise is one reason Snowflake was able to compete with giants like Amazon, Google, and Oracle.

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Founder	Approximate Age
Benoit Dageville	~59 years old (SEC)
Thierry Cruanes	~58–59 years old (Forbes Richest)
Marcin Zukowski	Likely in his 50s, but exact age is not readily confirmed in reliable public sources. (CWI)

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Interesting Observation

When Snowflake was founded in **2012**, the founders were not young college graduates:

Benoit ≈ 46 years old

Thierry ≈ 45 years old

Marcin ≈ 40s

They had already spent **15–25 years** becoming world-class database experts before starting Snowflake. That deep experience was a major reason the company succeeded.

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